SPIRITUAL/RELIGIOUS FALSE BELIEF #3 · GOD

“God is disappointed in me.”

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Where it often comes from

A parent who was often critical, hard to please, or quietly disappointed. High expectations at home or at church that you never felt you met. Comparing yourself to “model Christians” and coming up short. Repeated struggles with the same sin. A sensitive conscience that turns every mistake into proof of failure.

What Scripture teaches

God is not surprised or let down by your weakness. He knows exactly how you are made, and He has compassion on you like a loving father. When He corrects you, it is out of love and for your good, not because He has given up on you. He takes delight in you, and He has promised to finish the good work He began in you.

> *“As a father has compassion on his children, so the LORD has compassion on those who fear him; for he knows how we are formed, he remembers that we are dust”* **(Psalm 103:13–14)**.

Also see

> “The LORD your God is with you, the Mighty Warrior who saves. He will take great delight in you; in his love he will no longer rebuke you, but will rejoice over you with singing” **(Zephaniah 3:17)**.

> “Being confident of this, that he who began a good work in you will carry it on to completion until the day of Christ Jesus” **(Philippians 1:6)**.

> “For we do not have a high priest who is unable to empathize with our weaknesses, but we have one who has been tempted in every way, just as we are—yet he did not sin. Let us then approach God’s throne of grace with confidence, so that we may receive mercy and find grace to help us in our time of need” **(Hebrews 4:15–16)**.

> “Therefore, there is now no condemnation for those who are in Christ Jesus” **(Romans 8:1)**.

Common self-statements

- God must be tired of me by now.
- I keep letting God down.
- Nothing I do is ever good enough for God.
- God expected more from me.
- If I were really a Christian, I wouldn’t still struggle with this.
- God sighs when He looks at me.

Common logical errors

- **Mind reading:** Assuming that you know God feels let down by you, without evidence from Scripture.
- **Projection:** Picturing God with the same disappointed face as a critical parent or teacher.
- **Global labeling:** Turning “I fell short in this area” into “I am a disappointment.”
- **Should statements:** Holding yourself to “I should be further along by now” and assuming God holds the same rule.
- **Mental filter:** Focusing on your failures while ignoring the ways God has been growing you.

- **Emotional reasoning:** Concluding “I feel like a letdown, so God must be disappointed in me.”

Challenging questions

- What is the actual evidence that God is disappointed in me?
- Whose disappointment am I really remembering: God’s, or someone from my past?
- Can God be disappointed by something He knew about before I was born?
- Does a loving father give up on a child who is still learning?
- Am I mistaking God’s loving correction for rejection?
- Have I overlooked ways God has already been changing me?
- If God promised to finish His work in me, why would He be disappointed that I am still in progress?

Truth summary

> God is not disappointed in me. He knows exactly how I am made, and He has compassion on me like a loving father. When He corrects me, it is for my good, not because He has given up on me. He delights in me, and He will finish the good work He began in me. I am a work in progress, held in His love.

Related Pearls topics

Click a topic to open it in the Pearls Scripture Search:

- Love, By God
- Grace
- Mercy
- Guilt/Shame
- Rebuke/Correction
- Self-Esteem, Low

Godly Counsel Lessons:

From the book *Godly Counsel* by Dr. Brian Campbell. Click a lesson to open it. You can read it on screen or print it.

- Love
- Self-Esteem, Low
- Forgive/Forgiveness

Listen: Overcoming Depression

> **Overcoming Depression** · Dr. Brian Campbell · about 20 minutes

Each morning ask: “If I truly believed God’s truth instead of this lie, how would I think, speak, and act today?”

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HOMEWORK · REPLACE AND REHEARSE

My Plan for Replacing "God is disappointed in me"

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Read through each section and **check the one that fits you best**. If none of them fit, write your own. One choice per section is enough. A truth you choose for yourself will stick better than one handed to you.

Name: _____ **Date started:** _____

1 How strongly do I believe the lie?

Rate it now so you can see your progress later.

"God is disappointed in me." I believe this _____ % (0 = not at all, 100 = completely)

2 My best question

The one question I will ask myself every time the lie shows up.

- ☐ What is the actual evidence that God is disappointed in me?
- ☐ Whose disappointment am I really remembering?
- ☐ Can God be let down by something He always knew?
- ☐ Am I mistaking God's loving correction for rejection?
- ☐ Have I overlooked ways God is already changing me?
- ☐ Does a loving father give up on a child who is still learning?

My own question: _____

3 My replacement truth

The statement I will say to myself instead of the lie.

- ☐ God knows how I am made and has compassion on me.
- ☐ God delights in me.
- ☐ I am a work in progress, and God will finish what He started.
- ☐ God's correction is love, not rejection.
- ☐ My struggles do not surprise God.
- ☐ I can come to God with confidence, even when I fall short.

In my own words: _____

4 My Scripture

The verse that speaks most directly to me. This is the one I will memorize.

- [ ] **Psalm 103:13–14**
  "As a father has compassion on his children, so the LORD has compassion on those who fear him; for he knows how we are formed, he remembers that we are dust."
- [ ] **Zephaniah 3:17**
  "The LORD your God is with you, the Mighty Warrior who saves. He will take great delight in you; in his love he will no longer rebuke you, but will rejoice over you with singing."
- [ ] **Philippians 1:6**
  "Being confident of this, that he who began a good work in you will carry it on to completion until the day of Christ Jesus."
- [ ] **Hebrews 4:15–16**
  "For we do not have a high priest who is unable to empathize with our weaknesses, but we have one who has been tempted in every way, just as we are—yet he did not sin. Let us then approach God's throne of grace with confidence, so that we may receive mercy and find grace to help us in our time of need."
- [ ] **Romans 8:1**
  "Therefore, there is now no condemnation for those who are in Christ Jesus."

A verse I found myself: _____

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HOMEWORK · REPLACE AND REHEARSE

Practicing the Truth

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5 My practice plan

Everyone does the first three. Then pick one or two extra tools.

EVERYONE DOES THESE

- ☐ **Make my Truth Card** (below). Carry it and read it at least three times a day.
- ☐ **Memorize my Scripture** from Step 4.
- ☐ **Set reminders** to silently repeat my truth. Check one or more:
  - ☐ **A buzz:** my watch or phone vibrates every _____ minutes
  - ☐ **An everyday event:** every time I _____
  - ☐ **A visual reminder:** something I will see often, such as a sticky note on my mirror, my truth as the background picture on my phone, or a note on my car dashboard.

PICK ONE OR TWO THAT FIT ME

- ☐ **Evidence log:** Each day, write down one way God has grown or changed me, however small.
- ☐ **My name in Scripture:** Rewrite my verse with my name in it and read it aloud each morning.
  *For example, Zephaniah 3:17 becomes: "The LORD your God is with **Sarah**, the Mighty Warrior who saves. He will take great delight in **her**; in his love he will no longer rebuke **her**, but will rejoice over **her** with singing."*
- ☐ **Gratitude journal:** Each night, write three things I thank God for.
- ☐ **Truth recording:** Record my own voice reading my Truth Card and verse, and listen in the car or on a walk.
- ☐ **Reading:** The "Love, By God" topic in Pearls.
- ☐ **Listening:** The Overcoming Depression audio by Dr. Brian Campbell. Tap to play.

6 My action step this week

Do one thing that tests the lie in real life.

- ☐ **Write a "then and now" list:** three ways you are different today than five years ago because of God's work in you.
- ☐ **Accept a compliment** without explaining it away, and notice the urge to argue with it.
- ☐ **Make one mistake right,** then move on to a useful task instead of replaying it.
- ☐ **Ask a trusted Christian friend:** "What growth have you seen in me?" Write down their answer.

What I will do: _____

When: _____

What the lie predicts will happen: _____

7 End-of-week check-in

Bring this page to your next session.

What actually happened: _____

What I learned: _____

The lie "God is disappointed in me": _____ % **My truth:** _____ %

Daily practice tracker

Day	Read my card	Said my verse	Used my reminder	One way God is growing me
Mon				
Tue				
Wed				
Thu				
Fri				
Sat				
Sun				

My Truth Card

THE LIE

~~God is disappointed in me.~~

THE TRUTH

_____

_____

GOD'S WORD

_____

_____

Copy onto a 3×5 card, or cut along the dashed line and carry it with you.

Prayer

Father, help me reject the lie that You are disappointed in me. Thank You that You know how I am made and that You have compassion on me like a loving father. Help me receive Your correction as love, and trust that You will finish the good work You started in me. In Jesus' name, Amen.

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